

# Accessibility audit: Galaxium Travels sample app (Flights and Sign In)

|          |                                                                                                                             |
|----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Audit ID | EAR-2026-09-001                                                                                                             |
| Date     | 25 September 2026                                                                                                           |
| Auditor  | py-tr (self-authored)                                                                                                       |
| Target   | IBM Galaxium Travels sample application, commit e4e18ae, run locally (frontend <code>http://localhost:5173</code> )         |
| Standard | WCAG 2.2, Level AA                                                                                                          |
| Method   | Keyboard only; NVDA 2026.2 screen reader with Google Chrome on Windows 11; visual inspection; source inspection where noted |
| Scope    | The <code>/flights</code> page, the Sign In dialog, and the site-wide layout                                                |

Self-authored for demonstration. This is not a compliance statement or a certification. Context: the European Accessibility Act (Directive (EU) 2019/882) has applied since 28 June 2025 and covers e-commerce and passenger-transport booking services; Galaxium Travels is a sample app used here for illustration.

## How to reproduce

**Start state for every key script:** open `/flights`, signed out, with the Filters panel collapsed. Put keyboard focus on the first flight card's "Select Seat Class" button (Earth → Mars). NVDA running, Chrome in the foreground.

**Verification column:** "ear" means the finding is verified by what NVDA announces for the key script. "human" means a person must judge the result; a screen-reader transcript cannot decide it.

## Summary of findings

| ID   | WCAG success criterion                                        | Location                                  | Severity | Verification |
|------|---------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|----------|--------------|
| F-01 | 4.1.2 Name, Role, Value (A); 2.4.3 Focus Order (A)            | Sign In dialog                            | High     | ear          |
| F-02 | 2.4.3 Focus Order (A)                                         | Sign In dialog                            | High     | ear          |
| F-03 | 1.3.1 Info and Relationships (A); 4.1.2 Name, Role, Value (A) | Sign In form fields                       | Medium   | ear          |
| N-01 | 2.2.2 Pause, Stop, Hide (A)                                   | Animated starfield background, every page | Medium   | human        |
| N-02 | 4.1.3 Status Messages (AA)                                    | <code>/flights</code> results count       | Medium   | human        |

## Findings

### F-01: The Sign In dialog is not announced and does not receive focus

|                       |                                                                                                                                                                 |
|-----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Key script            | Enter, Tab                                                                                                                                                      |
| Observed              | After Enter, the Sign In dialog appears on screen but NVDA announces nothing. The next Tab moves to the page behind the dialog: "Moon, link, heading, level 3". |
| Expected announcement | "Sign In, dialog", then "Close modal, button"                                                                                                                   |
| Impact                | A screen-reader user cannot find the dialog, so cannot sign in or book.                                                                                         |
| Verification          | ear                                                                                                                                                             |

## **F-02: Focus is not contained in the Sign In dialog and is lost when it closes**

|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|--------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Key script                     | Enter, Tab ×5, Shift+Tab, Escape                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Observed (with F-01 corrected) | After the last control ("Don't have an account? Register"), Tab leaves the dialog for the page behind it: "content info landmark, github.com, link". After Escape, focus drops to the page body and NVDA reads "link, github.com". |
| Expected announcement          | The fifth Tab wraps to "Close modal, button". After Escape: "Select Seat Class, button" (focus returns to the control that opened the dialog).                                                                                     |
| Depends on                     | F-01 (focus must first enter the dialog)                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Verification                   | ear                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |

## **F-03: Sign In fields are announced by their placeholder, not their label**

|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|--------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Key script                     | Enter, Tab, Tab                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Observed (with F-01 corrected) | "John Doe, edit, required, blank", then "john@example.com, edit, required, blank". The visible labels "Name" and "Email" are not associated with their inputs, so the example text is read as the field name. |
| Expected announcement          | "Name, edit", then "Email, edit"                                                                                                                                                                              |
| Depends on                     | F-01                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Verification                   | ear                                                                                                                                                                                                           |

## **N-01: Background animation cannot be paused**

|              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|--------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Where        | Every page: the starfield behind the content twinkles and drifts continuously.                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Observed     | The animation starts automatically, runs indefinitely alongside the content, and has no pause, stop or hide control. (Also noted, outside 2.2.2: it does not respond to the operating system's "reduce motion" setting; source inspection shows no reduced-motion check in the canvas animation loop.) |
| Expected     | A mechanism for the user to pause, stop or hide the animation (required by SC 2.2.2). Recommended practice, not required by 2.2.2: also honour the operating system's "reduce motion" setting (prefers-reduced-motion; related to SC 2.3.3, Level AAA).                                                |
| Verification | human. The problem is visual motion; a screen-reader transcript cannot show it.                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |

## **N-02: The results count is not announced when it changes**

|              |                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|--------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Key script   | Move focus to the search box, type "Mars"                                                                                                                                                   |
| Observed     | The visible text "Showing N flights" updates as the user types, but it is not a status message (source inspection: no live region), so screen-reader users are not told the result changed. |
| Expected     | The new count is announced politely, without interrupting typing.                                                                                                                           |
| Verification | human. Whether an announcement interrupts typing is a judgement about timing and frequency; a transcript alone cannot decide it.                                                            |